

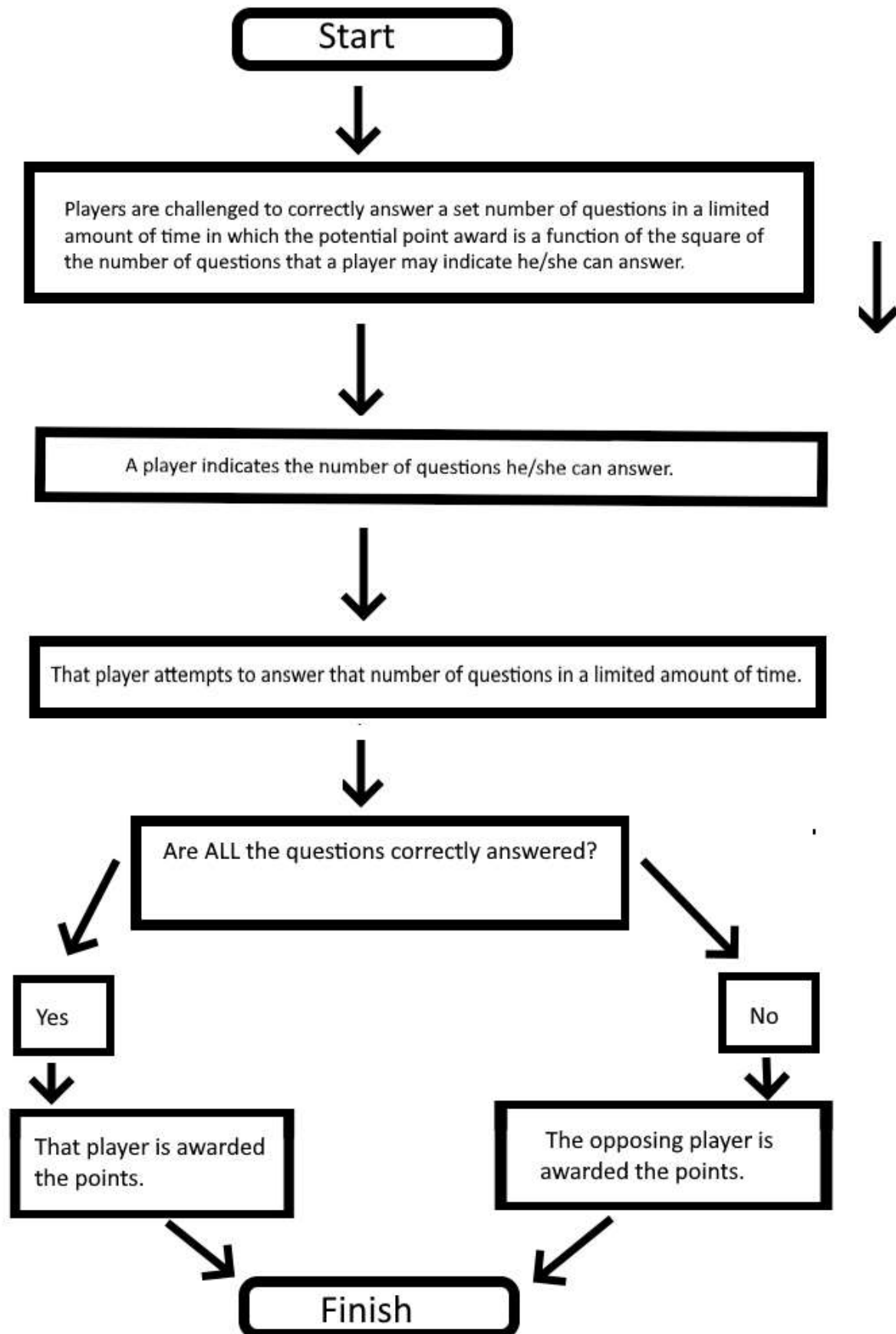
Background of the invention: Computer based competitive knowledge games today lack speed and excitement. Single questions are asked and then evaluated by the other players. The computer may be used to post the question and keep score, but not to evaluate the answer. The popular game *Jeopardy* asks a single question with players, using buzzers to go first, elect to give a verbal answer. The answer is then evaluated as to correctness by others.

Trivia SmackDown is different in that players are presented with multiple questions with players pressing one of multiple of buttons indicating how many of the questions they feel they can answer in a limited amount of time. The distinguishing feather of Trivia SmackDown is that the point award is computed as **the square of the number of questions to be answered**. Trivia SmackDown does not require the opposing player to evaluate the answers because of the way the material is presented on the computer as will be shown below.

Trivia SmackDown offers two other novel and unique ways to maintain the excitement and tempo of the game. The first way, by offering point rewards for the first player to elect to answer a question that requires all players to submit an analog answer with the closest answer winning. The second way, by presenting a question and then presenting hints over time as to the answer, with the players selecting answers using a drop Alphabet Button- and Drop-Down menu.

The First Case:

Flow Chart 1



The first type of Game presents a challenge that requires multiple answers that can be clicked-on or by moving objects.

In the screenshots below, Fig.1a -Fig.1c, two players, Peter and Paul, on the left and right side of the screen respectively each have 7 buttons above their names. The count of buttons represents the count of the number of answers to the question posed. In Fig.1a -Fig.1c it is “Which seven presidents are Democrats.?”

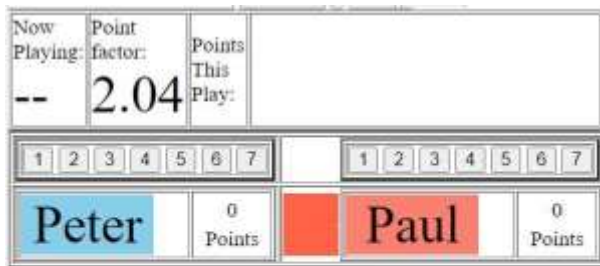


Fig. 1a

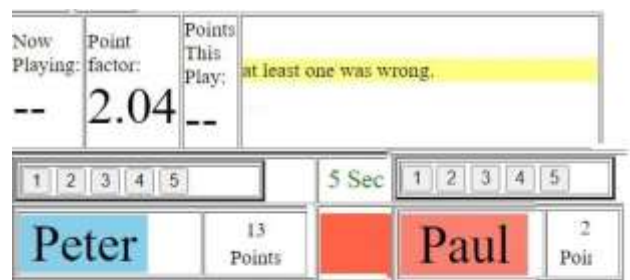


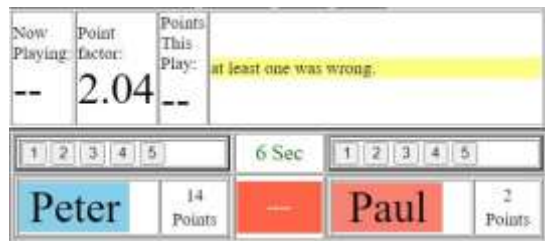
Fig. 1b



At any time, either player may elect to attempt to select up to all seven answers. The point award will be a function of the square of the number of answers the player may choose to select. For example, a single answer would be one point and all seven would be 49 points. But the downside is that if the player does not accomplish the challenge in the limited time allotted, or misses a single answer, the potential point award goes to the other side.

In Fig. 1b, Peter has pressed the “2” button and selected two of the presidents, which are now indicated to have already been chosen by the green dots. He has received 14 points which includes 6 points for answering the challenge before the allotted time. Notice that there are only 5 buttons remaining because two presidents have already been selected.

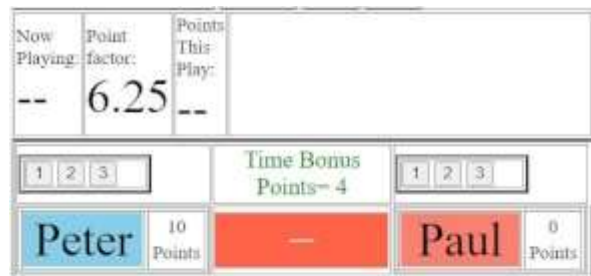
Also note that a game is composed of multiple rounds and in order to balance the whole game, the score is multiplied by a “Point factor” to make each Round equate to a perfect score near 100 points. This feature is not part of the claim but is hereby noted for clarity.



Which seven presidents are Democrats?



Fig. 1c



What four states are named after kings?

Georgia.



Fig. 2a

In Fig.1c, Peter had elected to choose another president and failed with the resulting 2 points going to Paul.

Fig. 2a shows a different screen where the question is to select the four states that are named after kings. Peter has answered with George and has received 10 points, 1 times a point factor of 6 plus 4 bonus points for answering the question before the allotted time ran out. Notice that the buttons above each player are reduced to three because one state, George, has been selected and is displayed on the blue line.

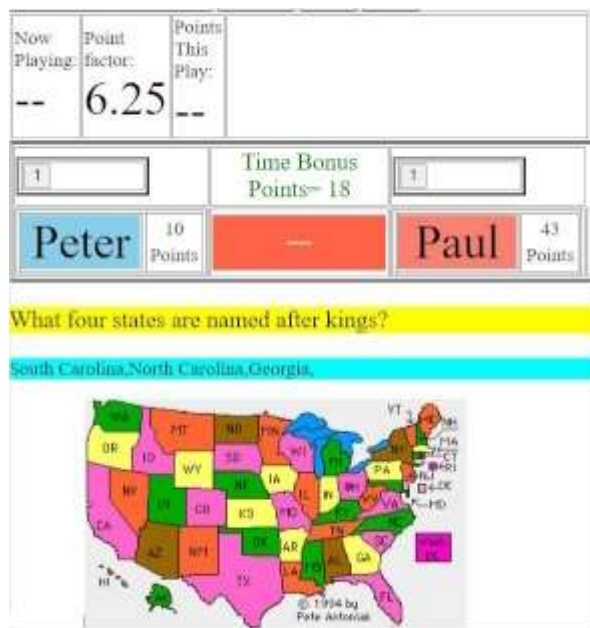


Fig. 2b



Fig. 2c

In Fig. 2b Paul has pressed the "2" button and clicked on North and South Carolina for a point award of 43. Also note that there is only one button left. Fig. 2c shows another screen asking to select the coins from the states of Vermont, Washington, and Wisconsin.



Fig. 3a

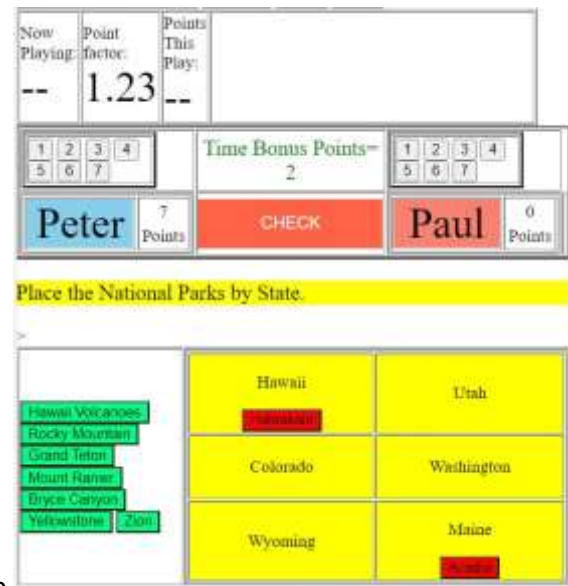


Fig. 3b

In Fig. 3a the players are challenged to drag the national parks into the states. Fig. 3b shows the results of Peter dragging two parks into the appropriate state and receiving 7 points.

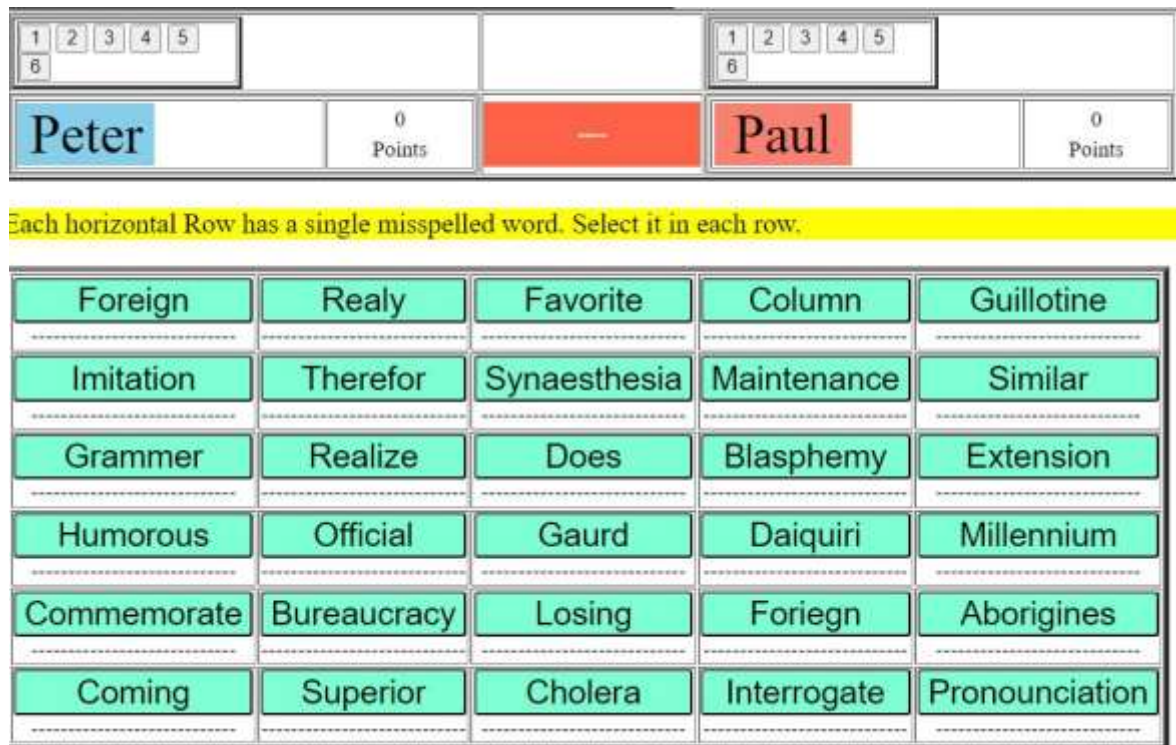


Fig. 4a

Fig. 4a shows a different kind of challenge in which players are to click on the misspelled word in each row.

Now Playing:	Point factor:	Points This Play:	
--	1.23	--	

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9		1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
Peter	0 Points	Paul
	CHECK	

Place the lines to The Raven by Edgar Allan Poe in their proper order.

suddenly there came a tapping while I pondered weak and weary Once upon a midnight dreary Over many a quaint As of someone gently rapping While I nodded nearly napping and curious volume of rapping at my chamber door forgotten lore

Fig. 5a

Now Playing:	Point factor:	Points This Play:	
--	1.23	--	Success!! You got them all right.

1 2 3 4 5 6	Time Bonus Points= 4	1 2 3 4 5 6
Peter	15 Points	Paul
	CHECK	

Place the lines to The Raven by Edgar Allan Poe in their proper order.

Over many a quaint As of someone gently rapping While I nodded nearly napping and curious volume of rapping at my chamber door forgotten lore	Once upon a midnight dreary while I pondered weak and weary suddenly there came a tapping
--	---

Fig. 5b

The above screens challenge the players to place the lines of a poem in the correct order. On the right, Peter has placed three lines for a point award of 15.

1 2 3 4 5 6	3 Sec	1 2 3 4 5 6
Peter	15 Points	Paul
	CHECK	

Place the lines to The Raven by Edgar Allan Poe in their proper order.

Over many a quaint As of someone gently rapping and curious volume of rapping at my chamber door forgotten lore	Once upon a midnight dreary While I nodded nearly napping while I pondered weak and weary suddenly there came a tapping
---	--

Fig. 5c

Now Playing:	Point factor:	Points This Play:	
Paul	1.23	11	PLAY STARTED!!

1 2 3 4 5 6	1 Sec	1 2 3 4 5 6
Peter	21 Points	Paul
	CHECK	

Place the lines to The Raven by Edgar Allan Poe in their proper order.

As of someone gently rapping rapping at my chamber door While I nodded nearly napping	Once upon a midnight dreary while I pondered weak and weary Over many a quaint and curious volume of forgotten lore suddenly there came a tapping
---	--

Fig. 5d

1 2 3	Time Bonus Points= 4	1 2 3
Peter	21 Points	Paul
	CHECK	

Place the lines to The Raven by Edgar Allan Poe in their proper order.

As of someone gently rapping rapping at my chamber door While I nodded nearly napping	Once upon a midnight dreary while I pondered weak and weary Over many a quaint and curious volume of forgotten lore suddenly there came a tapping
---	--

Fig. 5e

Fig.s 5a-e show a back and forth interplay attempting to put the lines to the poem "The Raven" back in order.

Answer these questions about the Elements.(Image Grid)

The Ozone Layer is composed of what element?

The 235 isotope of this element is used in making energy:

What element doomed the Hindenburg?

What element shares a name with the closest planet to the sun?

What are the two elements in table salt?

What element combines to form Helium in a fusion reaction?

Periodic Table of the Elements

H																	He										
Li	Be															B	C	N	O	F	Ne						
Na	Mg															Al	Si	P	S	Cl	Ar						
K	Ca	Sc	Ti	V	Cr	Mn	Fe	Co	Ni	Cu	Zn	Ga	Ge	As	Se	Br	Kr										
Rb	Sr	Y	Zr	Nb	Mo	Tc	Ru	Rh	Pd	Ag	Cd	In	Sn	Sb	Te	I	Xe										
Cs	Ba	La	Hf	Ta	W	Re	Os	Ir	Pt	Au	Hg	Tl	Pb	Bi	Po	At	Rn										
Fr	Ra	Ac	Unq	Unp	Unh	Uns	Uno	Une																			
			La											Ce	Pr	Nd	Pm	Sm	Eu	Gd	Tb	Dy	Ho	Er	Tm	Yb	Lu
			Ac											Th	Pa	U	Np	Pu	Am	Cm	Bk	Cf	Es	Fm	Md	No	Lr

Fig. 6a

In Fig. 6a, the problem of how to answer a question without going to multiple choice is solved by the use of a template of all possible answers. A player clicks on a question on the left and then an element on the right to answer it. Only after the given number of questions are processed is the play evaluated, and only if ALL the questions are correct does that player receive the points. If any question is incorrect or not enough questions are answered, the opposing player receives the points, and the questions remain unanswered and available for continued play by either side.

Answer these questions about the United States

What state name is a Spanish name of an imaginary island?

Des Moines and Davenport are major urban areas in what state?

What was the 48th state to join the Union?

Moscow USA is in what state?

The Yucca is the state flower and the Land of Enchantment is the nick name of what state?

Topeka is a major urban areas in what state?



Fig. 7a

Now Playing: 2.04

11:11:14 11:11

11 Sec 11:11:14 11:11

Peter 11:11:14 11:11

Paul 11:11:14 11:11

Answer questions about the American Revolution.

What was the date of the Battle of Bunker Hill?

What was the name of the British ship that was captured by the Continental Congress?

What was the name of the British ship that was captured by the Continental Congress?

What was the name of the British ship that was captured by the Continental Congress?

What was the name of the British ship that was captured by the Continental Congress?



Fig. 8a

Fig. 7a and Fig. 8a show examples of the use of templates to answer the questions.

Which are the only eight heavenly bodies that were know prior to 1600?

Sun	Titania	Mercury	Ganymede
Desdemona	Despina	Stephano	Bianca
Earth	Saturn	Sycorax	Ophelia
Moon	Jupiter	Cordelia	Larissa
Mars	Umbriel	Caliban	Venus

Fig. 9a

Now Playing:	Point factor:	Points This Play:	
--	2.04		
1 2 3 4 5 6 7		1 2 3 4 5 6 7	
Peter	0 Points	—	Paul
			0 Points

Complete the Bible sayings.

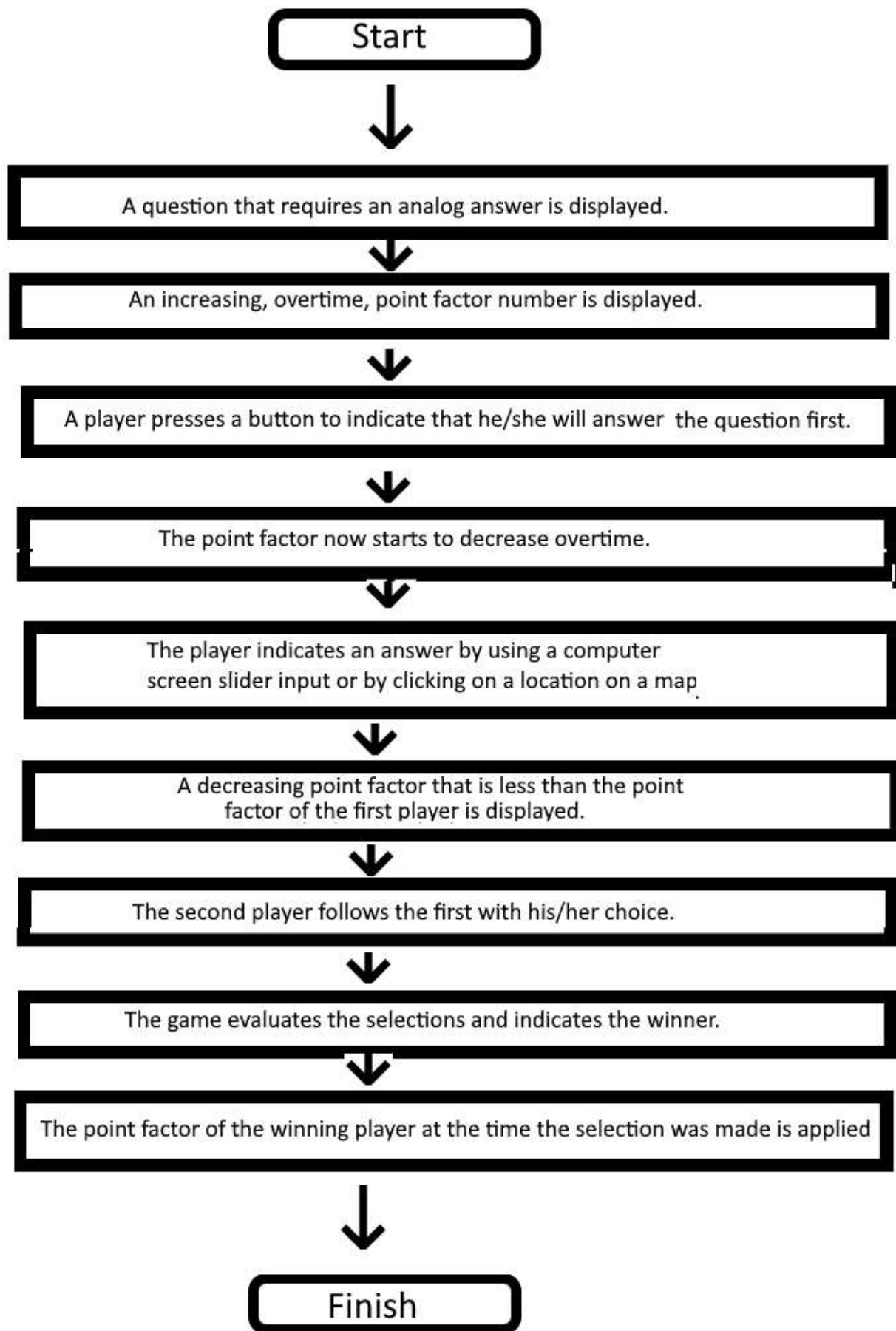
Read	the salt	shalt thou return.
The wolf	shall also dwell	all is vanity
Dust thou art	the handwriting	by bread alone.
Man	of vanities	hast thou forsaken me?
My God	does not live	of the earth
Vanity	and unto dust	with the lamb
You are	My God why	on the wall

Fig. 10a

Fig. 9a challenges the players to select the eight heavenly bodies that were known prior to 1600. Fig. 10a has players complete Bible sayings by clicking on the selection from left to right, consecutively.

The Second Case:

Flow Chart 2



The second type of game requires an analog answer, as opposed to a binary answer, like a number, a date, or a location. The winning player is the one who comes closest to the correct answer. Trivia SmackDown employs the use of an increasing “Point Factor” to get one of the players to go first. The challenge is presented with the question and a display of an increasing point factor. At any time either player may press the “Press to Go First” button and if that player wins, that point factor will be applied to his or her score.

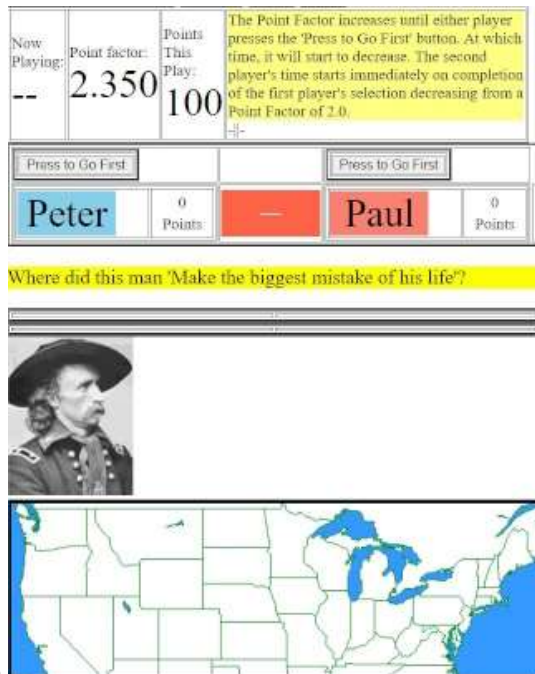


Fig. 11a



Fig. 11b

In Fig. 11a, players are challenged to click on a specific location on a map to answer the question of where the pictured man, in this case, Colonel Custer, made the biggest mistake of his life. When the screen shot was taken, the point factor was at 2.350 and increasing. Paul elected to go first, [with Peter then assigned to go second]. Fig. 11b shows the results of the play. Paul [the red dot] was closer than Peter [the blue dot] and gets 154 points. The large black “rifle sites” display indicates the correct location.



Fig. 12a



Fig. 12b

In the above screenshots, the players are asked for the date of the first moon landing and Paul has started by first selecting the year 1972 and in Fig. 12b, the month and day, 22 March.



Fig. 12c

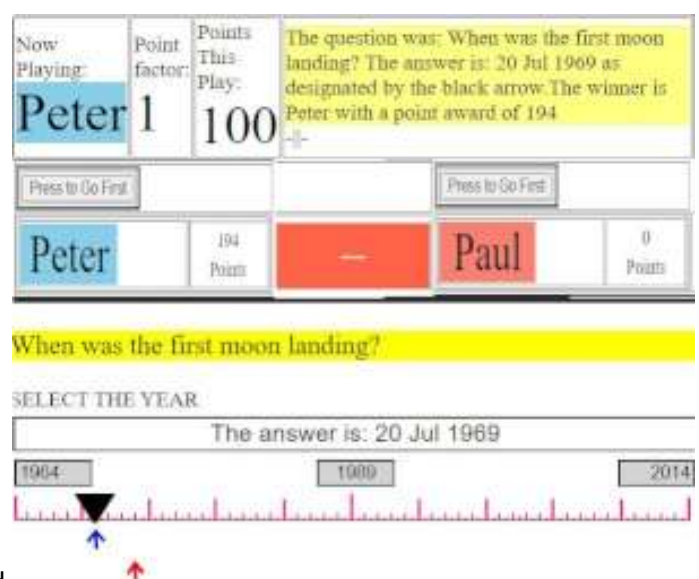


Fig. 12d

In Fig.12c, Peter has then selected 21 June 1969 and the play was immediately evaluated with the results of the selections and gave Peter 194 points with the colored arrows showing their mutual placements.

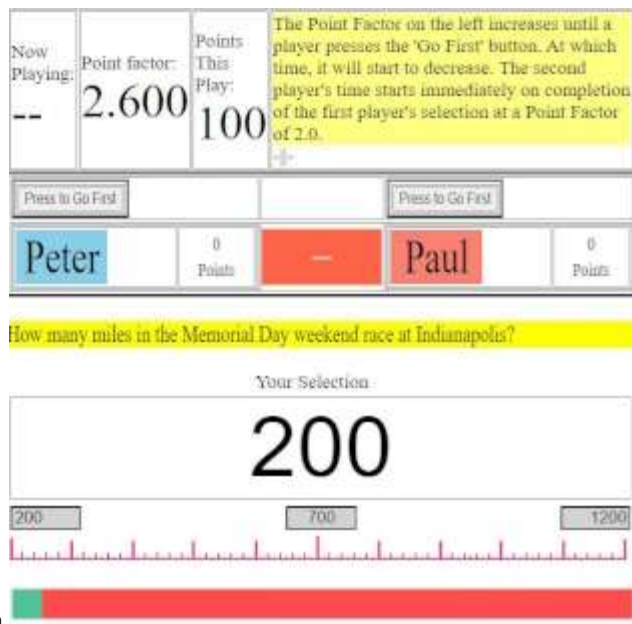
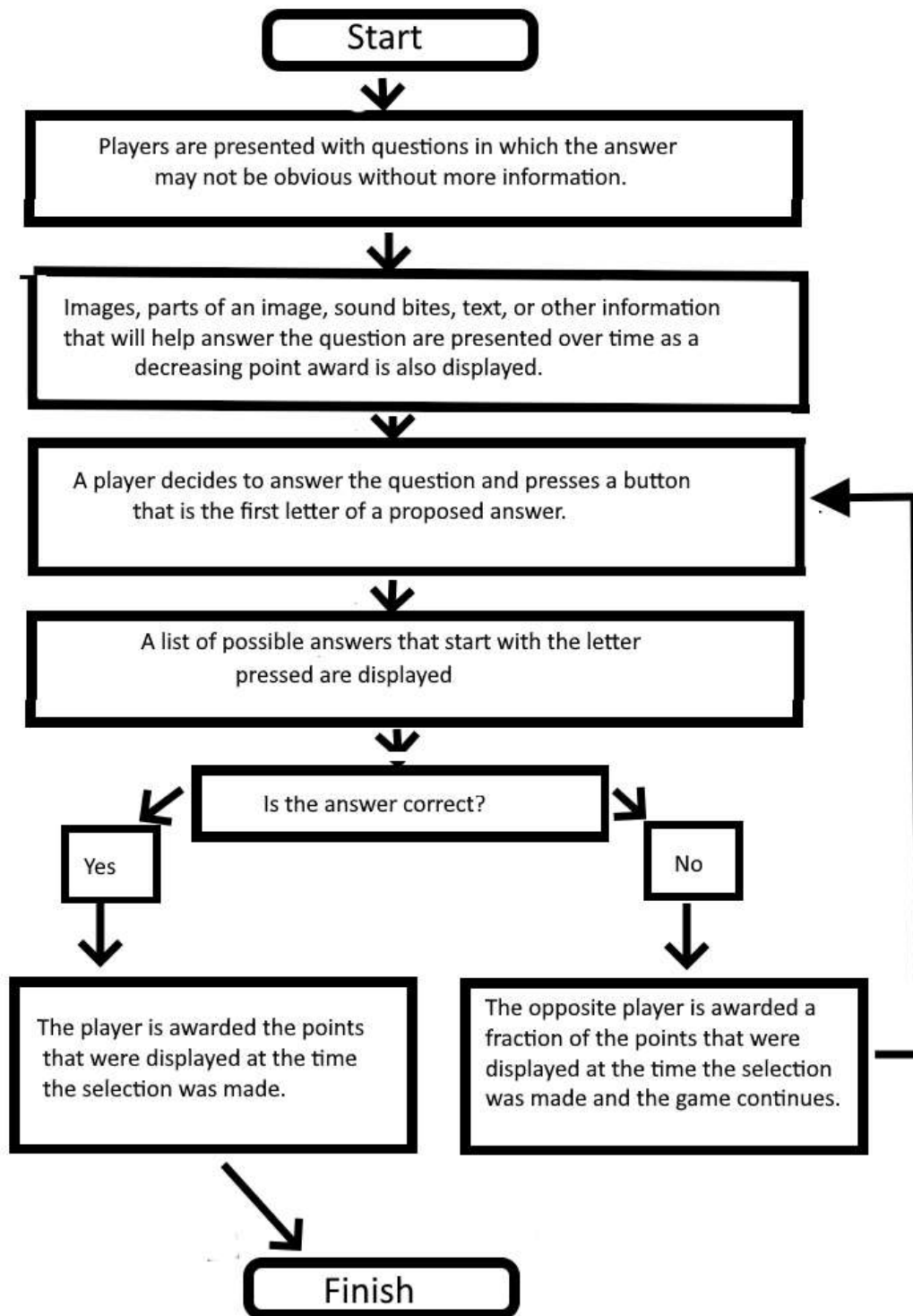


Fig. 13a

Fig. 13a, asks for an answer that is a number, and the play continues the same as with the dates challenge in Fig.s 12.

The Third Case:

.....



Flow Chart 3

The third type of challenge provides an ever-increasing amount of information, such as a images, sound bites, text or multimedia display to answer a question. As more information is presented, the point potential decreases. At any time either player may elect to answer the question by pressing one of the Alphabet Letter button indicating the first letter of a possible answer. A drop-down menu is then displayed listing all the possible answers that begin with that initial first letter.

It is important to note that it is not multiple choice, in that the possible answers are not displayed until a player elects to answer the questions and, in an order of magnitude, there are more answers than would be displayed in multiple choice. So that the player must really think he or she knows the answer before pressing that Alphabet Letter button. If answered correctly, that player receives points and the play is over. However, if the answer is incorrect, the opponent is awarded points and the game continues.

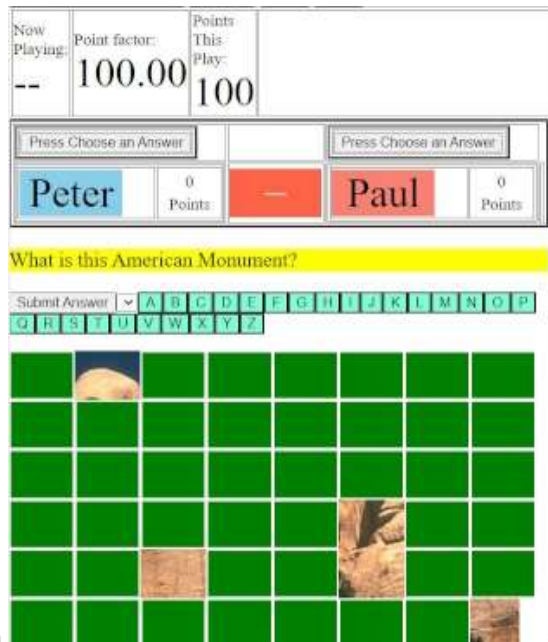


Fig. 14a

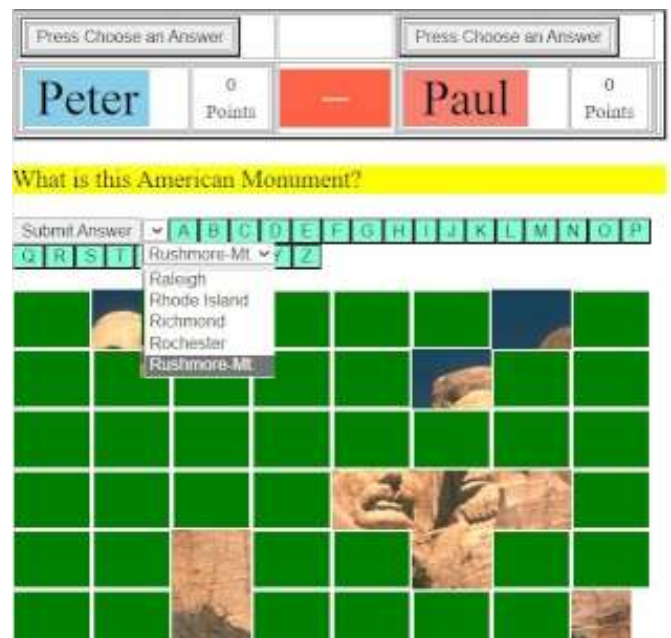


Fig. 14b

In Fig. 14a, part of an image is randomly being exposed. Either player, at any time may elect to select an answer to the question "What is this American Monument?" On Fig. 14b, more of the image has been exposed and Paul has pressed the "Press Choose an Answer" button and then he pressed the letter "R" on the green Alphabet Bar. This causes a drop-down menu of all the possible answers that start with "R" to appear and Paul selects "Rushmore-Mt." Fig. 14c shows the results.



Fig. 14c

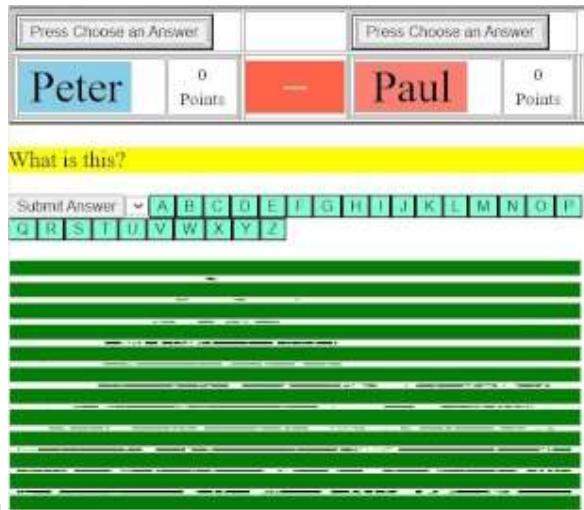


Fig. 15a

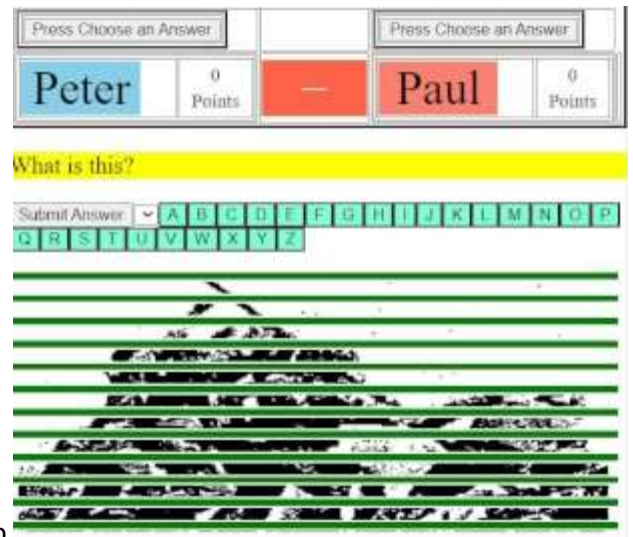


Fig. 15b

Fig. 15a displays another way of slowly exposing the images, like a venetian blind which continued in Fig. 15b and Fig. 15c to expose the Jima Memorial.

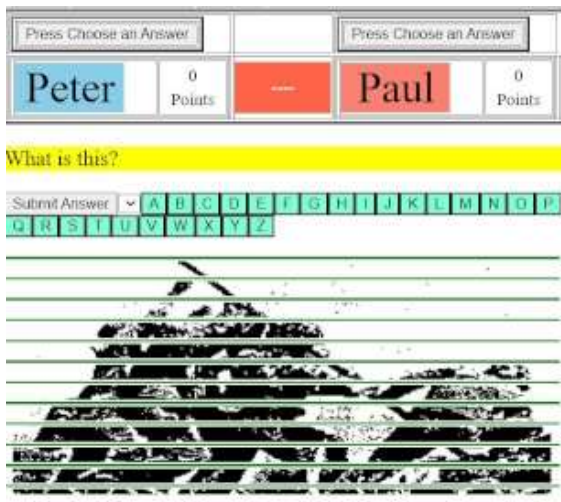


Fig. 15c

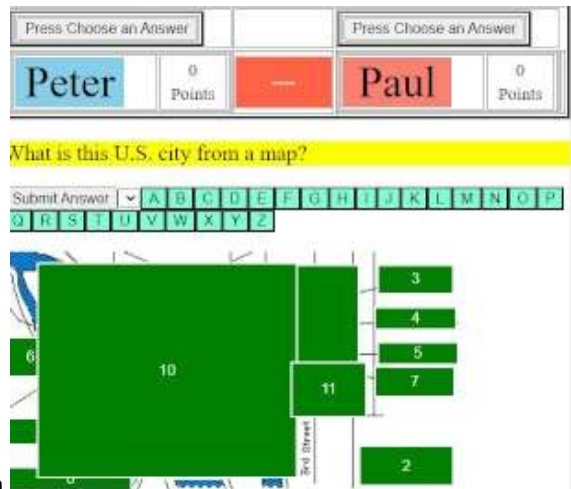


Fig. 16a

Fig. 16a asked what city is being map is being exposed. What is hidden from view and the order in which things are exposed is not random but specified by the Round Author.

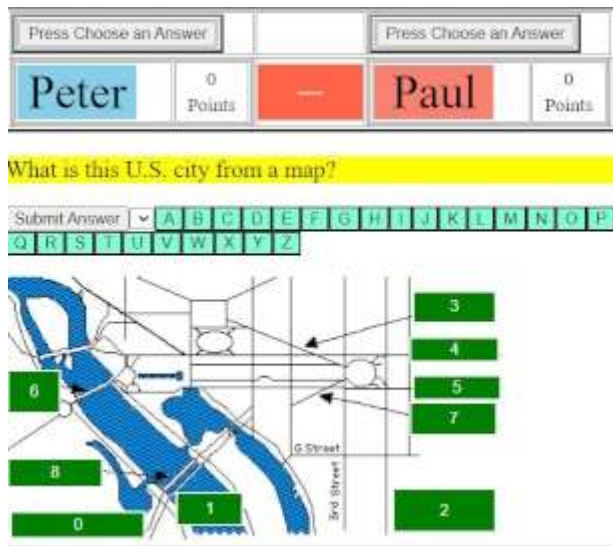


Fig. 16b

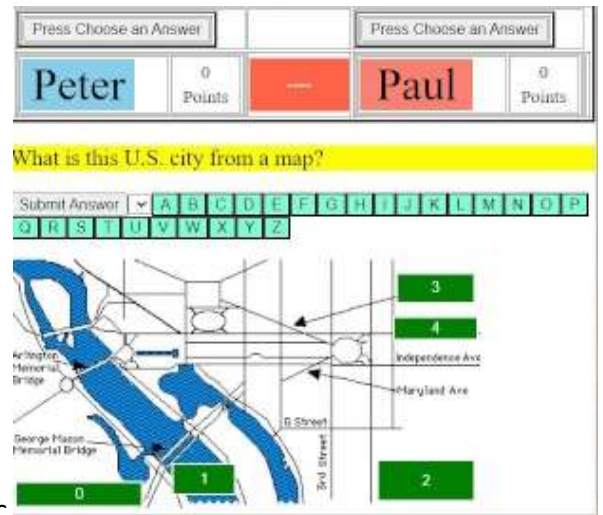


Fig. 16c

In Fig. 16b and Fig. 16c, more and more of the map is being selectively exposed.

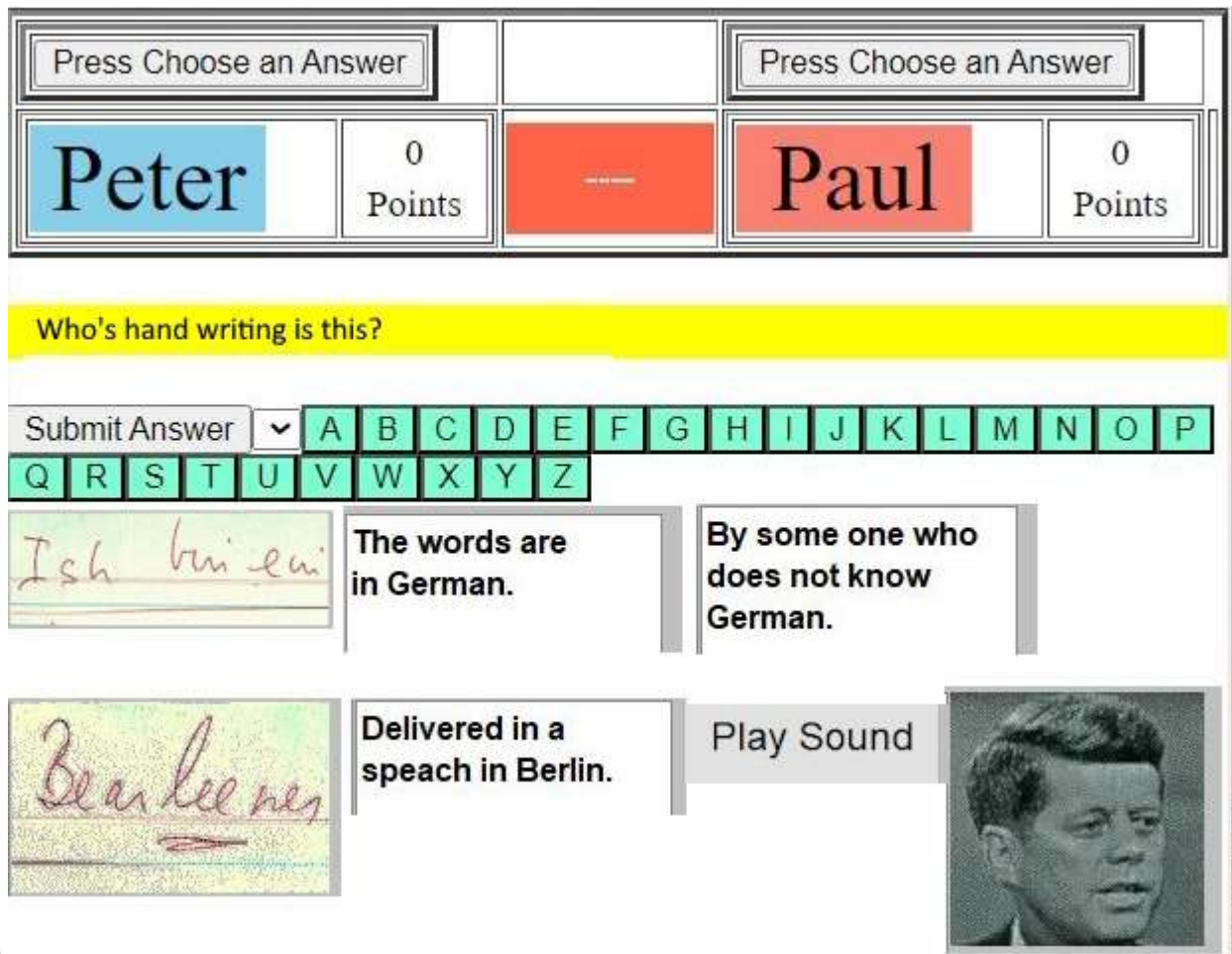


Fig. 17a

Fig. 17a shows the completed game in which the question was "Who's hand writing was this?". Each item is shown starting with some illegible scribbling on a yellow note pad and other hints presented over time with the "Play Sound" button playing Kennedy's famous "In am a Jelly donut speech." The selection process is accomplished the same as in the other case three examples.

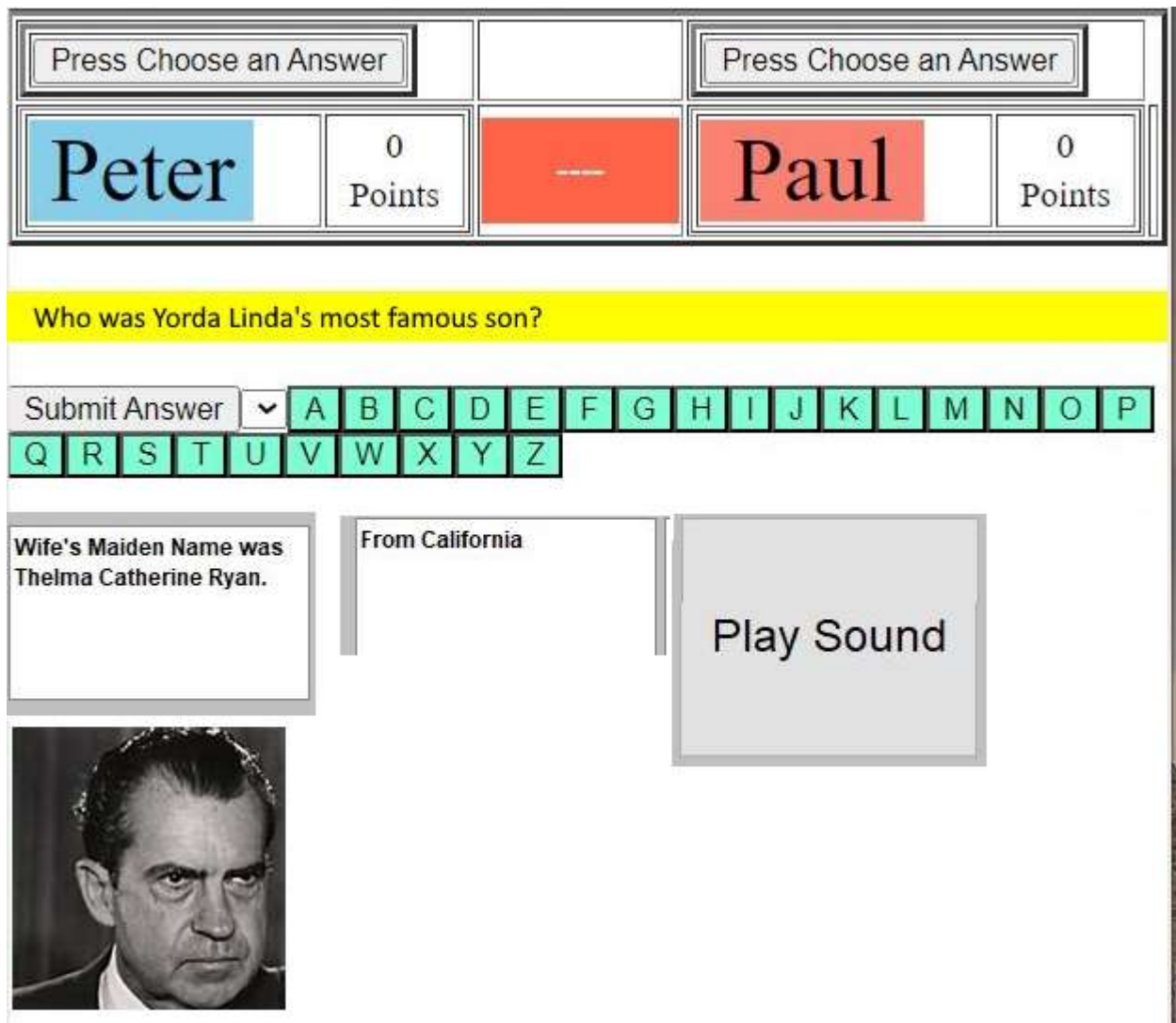


Fig. 18a

Fig. 18a shows the results of another progression of information with the “Play Sound” button the famous “In am not a crook.” speech of Nixon. The selection is accomplished the same as in the other Case Three examples.

CLAIM ONE: A competitive knowledge game on a display device in which multiple players are challenged to correctly move or click-on a limited number of objects or to answer a limited number of questions displayed on said display device by using an input device to indicate the number objects to be so moved, clicked-on or questions to be answered in which a potential score is a power of the number so indicated and in which a time allotted to accomplish said challenge is a linear function of the number so indicated and in which a player who has indicated by using said input device on said display device the number of objects to be correctly move, or questions to be correctly answered, will receive said potential point award only if all of said indicated number of objects are correctly moved or click-ed on, or questions answered in the time indicated, and in which, if not correctly moved clicked-on or answered in the time indicated, a point award is allotted to the opposing players.

CLAIM TWO: A competitive knowledge game on a display device in which multiple players are challenged to correctly answer a question in which the answer is analog number, such as a location on a map, a number or a date and in which,

in order to induce a player to go first, an increasing over time bonus point factor is displayed, said point factor, being applied to said first player who elects to answer the challenge if said player wins the challenge .

CLAIM THREE: A competitive knowledge game on a display device in which multiple players are challenged to correctly answer a question in which the display device is presenting, over time, an increasing amount of information helpful to answering said question and in which the answer to said question is selected from a menu of possible answers to said question that is displayed only after a player elects to answer said question by selecting, using an input device, the first letter of a proposed answer to said question and in which, if said answer is correct answered receives points, and in which said question if incorrectly answered, the opposing players receive points.